

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear functions	Easy

Question

For the linear function f , the graph of $y = f(x)$ in the xy -plane has a slope of $\frac{1}{4}$ and passes through the point $(0, 5)$. Which equation defines f ?

Answer

- A. $f(x) = \frac{1}{4}x + 5$
- B. $f(x) = \frac{1}{4}x + \frac{1}{5}$
- C. $f(x) = \frac{1}{4}x - \frac{5}{4}$
- D. $f(x) = \frac{1}{4}x - 5$

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is correct. An equation that defines a linear function f can be written in the form $f(x) = mx + b$, where m is the slope of the graph of $y = f(x)$ in the xy -plane and $(0, b)$ is the y -intercept of the graph. It's given that for the linear function f , the graph of $y = f(x)$ in the xy -plane has a slope of $\frac{1}{4}$. Therefore, $m = \frac{1}{4}$. It's also given that the graph of $y = f(x)$ passes through the point $(0, 5)$. Therefore, the y -intercept of the graph is $(0, 5)$, and it follows that $b = 5$. Substituting $\frac{1}{4}$ for m and 5 for b in the equation $f(x) = mx + b$ yields $f(x) = \frac{1}{4}x + 5$.

Choice B is incorrect. This equation defines a function whose graph has a y -intercept of $(0, \frac{1}{5})$, not $(0, 5)$.

Choice C is incorrect. This equation defines a function whose graph has a y -intercept of $(0, -\frac{5}{4})$, not $(0, 5)$.

Choice D is incorrect. This equation defines a function whose graph has a y -intercept of $(0, -5)$, not $(0, 5)$.